According to Just Peace International (JPI), an NGO that ran a project with the financial assistance of the Greek-based charity European Union Perspective, about 85 per cent of the displaced population living with host communities had experienced problems, because they lost their social identities when they had to leave their homes.

'The people of the conflict areas are exposed to high levels of violence,' said Imdad Bashir, a consulting psychiatrist with JPI. 'We have so far seen 255 patients, including 177 women.'

Anxiety and mistrust were common among conflict-zone residents, Bashir said. Every third person in South and North Waziristan, Bajaur and Swat suffered from depression, and many women and children complained of recurring nightmares of blood-splattered bodies and homeless families living in destitution, he said.

As Ali stated, 'The problem is most of the patients face relapses.' Victims of violence needed regular psychological services, counselling and treatment to help them overcome the trauma.

The doctors could not reach everyone, though, and part of that is society's fault. 'People do not consider (mental) trauma a health concern,' said Ali.

Also, patients had shunned the JPI clinic in Batkhela out of fear of militants, Bashir said, explaining that JPI was planning to establish free psychiatric clinics in other conflict zones.

As he stated, 'But we plan to have workshops in the violence-prone areas when law and order improves.' 'Now, people aren't consulting psychiatrists because of the social stigma. In nutshell, better public awareness is needed.'

Children were the worst hit due to persistent episodes of terrorism and mayhem and they evinced a broad range of symptoms of mental illness. Children are most likely to take serious impact on their little minds and hearts. According to a survey, the children in New York City showed a broad range of mental health symptoms six months after the 11 September 2001 terrorist attack on the World Trade Center (Lamberg, 2003). However, there was no survey carried out by the researches to see which symptoms persisted in the children in KP and other parts of Pakistan. But various cases depicted a vivid picture about it. A 12-year-old girl brought to the psychiatry ward was suffering from anxiety and fear, Jawad Ali, a psychiatrist at the Khyber Teaching Hospital, Peshawar, said. She had witnessed a suicide bomb blast.